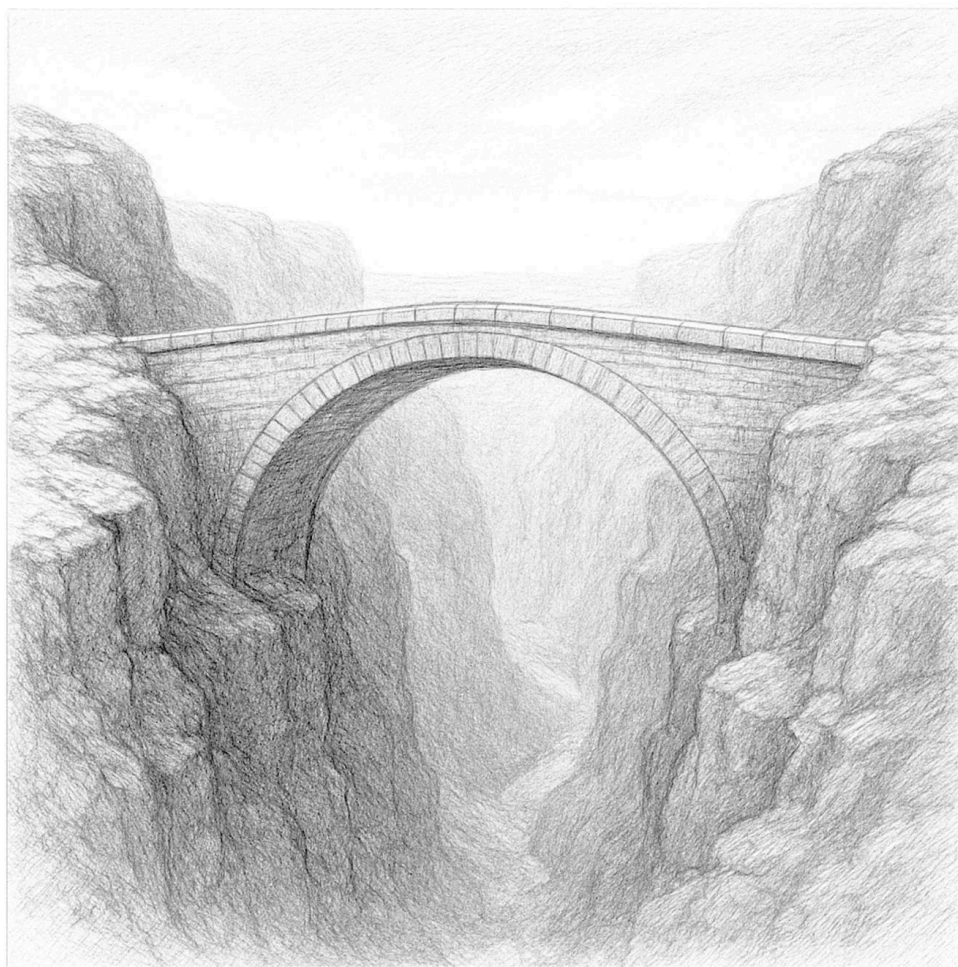


Mediation



A stone arch crosses a gorge no one is going to jump. The cliffs do not move closer. The bridge is the only way, and it had to be built from both sides.

Before you gather

- Read Day 16, Mediation, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Hebrews 7:23–25 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What gap would you not try to cross without someone to go between?

Leader. A gap needs a go-between. Then open Hebrews 7. Jesus always lives to intercede. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: There is one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus, who gave Himself as a ransom. We are not the mediator.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Mediation is the work of Jesus Christ, the God-man, by which He stands between God and sinful humanity as the only representative who reconciles the two by His atoning death and ongoing intercession as our Great High Priest.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek mesitēs — one who stands in the middle, a go-between.

MEMORY VERSE · 1 TIMOTHY 2:5–6

For there is one God, and there is one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus, who gave himself as a ransom for all.

Together, open the flashcard for Mediation. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Hebrews 7:23–25

1 Timothy 2:5–6 is the memory verse. Stay in Hebrews 7:23–25. The point is Christ's priesthood, not our spiritual effort.

The former priests were many in number, because they were prevented by death from continuing in office, but he holds his priesthood permanently, because he continues forever. Consequently, he is able to save to the uttermost those who draw near to God through him, since he always lives to make intercession for them.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. Why could the old priests not continue forever, and what does verse 24 say about Jesus? CORE

Leader. They died. Jesus holds His priesthood permanently because He continues forever. He is able to save to the uttermost those who draw near through Him.

2. Verse 25 says He always lives to make intercession. What is He doing now for those who draw near?

Leader. He prays for them. He is not done at the cross and then absent. He saves to the uttermost. Draw near through Him, not through another priest.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. 1 Timothy 2:5 says there is one mediator, the man Christ Jesus. What does “one” forbid?

Leader. Any other go-between: a saint, a pastor, Mary, your own record. One mediator. Say it clearly and kindly.

4. Verse 6 says He gave Himself as a ransom for all. How do you say that to a friend without turning yourself into their priest? CORE

Leader. Point them to Jesus. Tell them He died as a ransom. Offer to pray with them. Do not stand in His place.

5. Hebrews 4:15–16 says we have a high priest who sympathizes, so we draw near with confidence. What keeps people from drawing near?

Leader. Shame, the idea that they must clean up first, or trust in someone else. The text says draw near through Him.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Jesus is the one mediator. He gave Himself as a ransom, and He still lives to pray for His people.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Help someone who has no one to speak for them — a meeting, a bill, a hard conversation. Then tell them there is one mediator, the man Christ Jesus, who gave Himself as a ransom.

Leader. Say out loud that you are not the mediator if anyone starts to feel heroic. Name Christ. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Lord Jesus, You are the one mediator. We come through You.
2. Thank You that You live to intercede for Your people.
3. Give us courage to point one person to You and not to ourselves.

Before you stumble

Do not let the room invent other mediators. And do not let a helpful Christian become the hero of someone else's standing before God. One mediator. Also "ransom for all" is a real offer to be preached to all. It does not mean every person is already saved apart from faith.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask who they would want to walk into the principal's office with them. Then ask why Jesus is better than that friend. He died and He lives.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

John 14:6. No one comes to the Father except through Him. Read it if someone is still looking for another door.